

# THE BUZZ

## ECONOMY

# FIRM FOOTING

The *BT-C* Fore Business Confidence Index is at a six-quarter high. Businesses are confident of a sustained recovery in demand this festive season, but the Middle East conflict is dampening sentiment

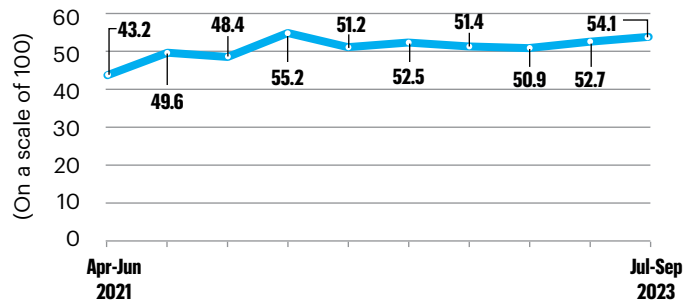
BY SURABHI

► **SIX MONTHS INTO** financial year 2023-24 (FY24), the Indian economy seems to be on firm footing, nimbly meeting unforeseen challenges, as it looks poised to grow 6.5 per cent this fiscal. This is reflected in the faith businesses are reposing in the country's ability to navigate the turbulence—both domestic and global. They are also upbeat about festive season demand, despite some anxiety over the fallout of the Israel-Hamas war and its impact on oil prices and global economic stability.

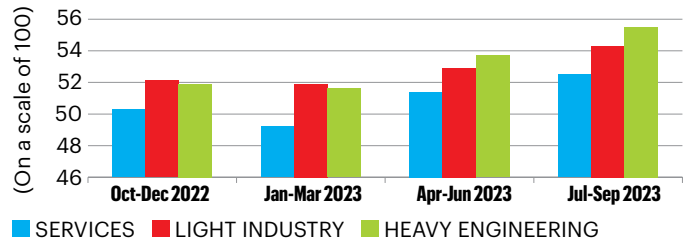
This sentiment is apparent from the *BT-C* Fore Business Confidence Survey (of 500 CEOs and CFOs) for the July–September quarter (Q2) of FY24. The Business Confidence Index (BCI) touched a six-quarter high of 54.1 in Q2FY24, as against 52.7 in Q1FY24. Before this, the BCI had touched a high of 55.2 in Q4FY22, when the economy had just begun recovering from two years of the Covid-19 pandemic.

## OPTIMISM GROWS AS RECOVERY PICKS UP PACE

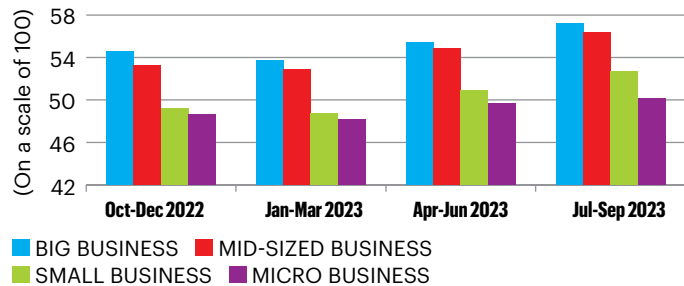
### BCI AT A SIX-QUARTER HIGH



## BCI SEES SHARP RISE ACROSS INDUSTRIES



## POSITIVE GAINS ACROSS BUSINESS SIZES



## FIRMS ARE MOSTLY OPTIMISTIC ABOUT Q3

